

TEORÍA COMPLETA PARA LA PAU DE INGLÉS

Use of English · Phonetics · Writing · Rephrasing

Este documento contiene toda la gramática, fonética y estrategias necesarias para superar la prueba de acceso a la universidad. Incluye ejemplos de cada punto.

1. USE OF ENGLISH

1.1 Tiempos verbales

Presente

- Present Simple: hábitos, hechos generales → I work, he works
- Present Continuous: ahora, planes futuros → I am working
- Present Perfect: experiencias, resultados pasados con relevancia → I have worked
- Present Perfect Continuous: acción que empezó en el pasado y continúa → I have been working
 - ◆ *She has studied French for six years.*
 - ◆ *They are meeting tomorrow at 6 PM.*

Pasado

- Past Simple: acción completada → I worked / I did
- Past Continuous: en progreso en un momento del pasado → I was working
- Past Perfect: anterior a otra pasada → I had worked
- Past Perfect Continuous: duración antes de otra acción → I had been working
 - ◆ *When I arrived, they had already left.*
 - ◆ *He was watching TV when the phone rang.*

Futuro

- Will: predicciones, decisiones espontáneas → I will help you
- Going to: planes, evidencia → It is going to rain
- Present Continuous: planes fijos → I am flying to London next week
- Future Perfect: completado antes de un momento futuro → I will have finished by 8 PM
- Future Continuous: en progreso en un momento futuro → This time tomorrow I will be flying
 - ◆ *By 2030, robots will have replaced many jobs.*

1.2 Oraciones condicionales

Tipo	If clause	Main clause	Uso
Zero	If + present simple	present simple	Hechos generales
First	If + present simple	will + inf	Posibles/reales
Second	If + past simple	would + inf	Hipotéticos/improbables
Third	If + past perfect	would have + pp	Irreales (pasado)
Mixed	If + past perfect	would + inf	Condición pasada, resultado presente

Alternativas a 'if'

- Unless = if not → Unless you study, you will fail.
- Provided / providing that → You can go out provided you finish your homework.
- As long as → As long as you apologize, I'll forgive you.
- Even if → Even if it rains, we'll go.
- In case → Take an umbrella in case it rains.
 - ◆ *If I had woken up earlier, I wouldn't have missed the bus. (Third)*
 - ◆ *If I were rich, I would buy a yacht. (Second)*

1.3 Voz pasiva y causativa

- Formación: be + past participle. Sujeto de la activa → complemento agente (by)
- Present simple: The house is cleaned every day.
- Past simple: The house was cleaned yesterday.
- Present perfect: The house has been cleaned.
- Future: The house will be cleaned.
- Modals: The house must be cleaned.

Pasiva personal e impersonal

- Verbos: say, think, believe, report, know, claim
- Estructura 1: It is said that + sujeto + verbo
- Estructura 2: Sujeto + is said + to infinitive
 - ◆ *People say she speaks six languages → It is said that she speaks six languages / She is said to speak six languages.*
 - ◆ *They think the thief escaped → The thief is thought to have escaped.*

Causative: have / get something done

- have + objeto + past participle → I had my car repaired (alguien lo reparó por mí)
- get + objeto + past participle → I got my hair cut
 - ◆ *She is having her house painted at the moment.*
 - ◆ *We need to get the documents signed by the manager.*

1.4 Estilo indirecto

Cambios de tiempo (backshifting)

Directo	Indirecto
Present simple → I work	Past simple → He said he worked
Present continuous → I am working	Past continuous → He said he was working
Past simple → I worked	Past perfect → He said he had worked
Past continuous → I was working	Past perfect continuous → He said he had been working
Present perfect → I have worked	Past perfect → He said he had worked
Will → I will work	Would → He said he would work
Can → I can work	Could → He said he could work
Must → I must work	Had to → He said he had to work

Cambios de lugar, tiempo, pronombres

- here → there; now → then; today → that day; tomorrow → the next/following day; yesterday → the day before; ago → before
- this → that; these → those

Preguntas en estilo indirecto

- Yes/No questions: if / whether + sujeto + verbo (sin do/does/did)
 - ◆ *He asked me: 'Do you like coffee?' → He asked me if I liked coffee.*
- Wh- questions: wh- word + sujeto + verbo
 - ◆ *She asked: 'Where do you live?' → She asked where I lived.*

Imperativos

- tell/order/ask + persona + to infinitive (negativo: not to)
 - ◆ *The teacher said: 'Sit down' → The teacher told us to sit down.*
 - ◆ *He said: 'Don't touch that' → He told me not to touch that.*

1.5 Verbos modales

Modal	Uso principal	Ejemplo
Can	Habilidad, permiso	I can swim. Can I leave?

Could	Habilidad pasada, petición cortés	I could run fast. Could you help?
May / Might	Posibilidad, permiso formal	It may rain. May I come in?
Must	Obligación fuerte, deducción cierta	You must stop. He must be tired.
Have to	Obligación externa	I have to work on Sundays.
Should / Ought to	Consejo, recomendación	You should see a doctor.
Need to	Necesidad	You need to study harder.
Needn't	Falta de necesidad	You needn't bring anything.
Mustn't	Prohibición	You mustn't smoke here.

Modales en pasado (deducción y crítica)

- must have + pp → deducción segura sobre el pasado: She must have forgotten the meeting.
- might / may / could have + pp → posibilidad: He might have missed the train.
- can't / couldn't have + pp → imposibilidad: They can't have arrived already.
- should / ought to have + pp → crítica sobre algo que no se hizo: You should have told me the truth.
- needn't have + pp → algo que se hizo pero no era necesario: You needn't have cooked, we ate out.
 - ◆ *She looks happy. She must have passed the exam.*
 - ◆ *You shouldn't have spent all your money.*

1.6 Oraciones de relativo

- Defining (especificativas): sin comas. Who (personas), which (cosas), that (personas/cosas), whose (posesión), whom (objeto formal)
- Non-defining (explicativas): con comas. No se puede usar 'that' ni omitir el pronombre.
 - ◆ *The book that I bought is excellent. (defining)*
 - ◆ *My brother, who lives in Madrid, is a doctor. (non-defining)*

Preposiciones en relativas

- En estilo formal: preposición + whom / which
- En informal: preposición al final (se puede omitir el pronombre)
 - ◆ *The company for which she works is very big. (formal)*
 - ◆ *The company (which/that) she works for is very big. (informal)*

1.7 Verb patterns (gerundio e infinitivo)

Verbos seguidos de -ing

- enjoy, avoid, mind, finish, suggest, consider, practise, miss, deny, imagine, risk
 - ◆ *I enjoy reading novels. He avoided answering the question.*

Verbos seguidos de to + infinitive

- want, need, decide, promise, hope, expect, agree, refuse, manage, learn, pretend
 - ◆ *She wants to become a doctor. They decided to leave early.*

Verbos que cambian de significado

Verbo	-ing	to infinitive
stop	Dejar de hacer algo: I stopped smoking (lo dejé)	Parar para hacer algo: I stopped to smoke (paré para fumar)
remember	Recordar algo que ya hice: I remember locking the door	Recordar que tengo que hacer algo: I remembered to lock the door
forget	Olvidar algo que hice: I'll never forget meeting you	Olvidar hacer algo: Don't forget to call
try	Probar, experimentar: Try pressing the button	Intentar (esforzarse): I tried to open it but couldn't
regret	Lamentar algo pasado: I regret telling her	Lamento decir (comunicar algo malo): We regret to inform you

1.8 Conectores (linking words)

Causa y efecto

- because / because of / due to / owing to / since / as
- so / therefore / consequently / as a result / thus
- ◆ *Due to the rain, the match was cancelled. It was raining, so we stayed home.*

Propósito

- to / in order to / so as to → infinitivo
- so that → para que (con would/can)
- ◆ *She left early not to miss the bus. He spoke loudly so that everyone could hear.*

Concesión y contraste

- Although / though / even though + oración
- Despite / in spite of + sustantivo / -ing
- However / nevertheless / on the other hand / whereas / while
- ◆ *Although it was cold, we went out. Despite being tired, she finished the race. He is rich; however, he is unhappy.*

Adición y ejemplificación

- Moreover, furthermore, in addition, besides, what's more
- For example, for instance, such as
- ◆ *The hotel was expensive. Furthermore, it was far from the beach. I like citrus fruits, such as oranges and lemons.*

2. PHONETICS (Fonética para la PAU)

En la PAU a menudo se pide transcripción fonética o identificar sonidos. Aquí tienes todos los fonemas del inglés con ejemplos.

2.1 Vocales (vowels)

Símbolo	Sonido	Ejemplo	Transcripción
/ɪ/	corta 'i'	bit	/bɪt/
/i:/	larga 'i'	see	/si:/
/ʊ/	corta 'u'	book	/bʊk/
/u:/	larga 'u'	too	/tu:/
/e/	'e' abierta	bed	/bed/
/ə/	schwa (neutra)	about	/ə'baʊt/
/ɜ:/	larga media	bird	/bɜ:d/
/ɔ:/	larga 'o' abierta	door	/dɔ:/
/æ/	'a' muy abierta	cat	/kæt/
/ʌ/	corta 'a' como en 'amor'	cup	/kʌp/
/ɑ:/	larga 'a' profunda	car	/kɑ:/
/ɒ/	corta 'o'	hot (UK)	/hɒt/

2.2 Diptongos (diphthongs)

Símbolo	Ejemplo	Transcripción
/eɪ/	say	/seɪ/
/aɪ/	my	/maɪ/
/ɔɪ/	boy	/bɔɪ/
/aʊ/	now	/naʊ/
/əʊ/	go (UK)	/qəʊ/
/ɪə/	here	/hɪə/
/eə/	hair	/heə/
/ʊə/	tour	/tʊə/

2.3 Consonantes (consonants)

Símbolo	Sonido (sorda/sonora)	Ejemplo	Transcripción
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/p/	sorda	pen	/pen/
/b/	sonora	book	/bʊk/
/t/	sorda	two	/tuː/
/d/	sonora	dog	/dɒɡ/
/k/	sorda	cat	/kæt/
/g/	sonora	go	/ɡəʊ/
/f/	sorda	fish	/fɪʃ/
/v/	sonora	very	/ˈveri/
/θ/	sorda (z interdental)	think	/θɪŋk/
/ð/	sonora (th inglesa)	this	/ðɪs/
/s/	sorda	see	/siː/
/z/	sonora	zoo	/zuː/
/ʃ/	sorda (sh)	she	/ʃiː/
/ʒ/	sonora (j francesa)	pleasure	/ˈpleʒə/
/tʃ/	sorda (ch)	chair	/tʃeə/
/dʒ/	sonora (y)	just	/dʒʌst/
/h/	sorda aspirada	house	/haʊs/
/m/	sonora	mother	/ˈmʌðə/
/n/	sonora	no	/nəʊ/
/ŋ/	sonora (ng)	sing	/sɪŋ/
/l/	sonora	light	/laɪt/
/r/	sonora	red	/red/
/w/	sonora (semiconsonante)	we	/wiː/
/j/	sonora (y)	yes	/jes/

2.4 Acentuación (stress)

- Las palabras de dos sílabas: sustantivos suelen acento en la primera (PREsent, OBject); verbos en la segunda (preSENT, objEct).
- Sufijos que cambian el acento: -ion (teleVIsion), -ic (scienTific), -ity (aCITity).
◆ *PHOtograph* (sustantivo), *phoTOgraphy*, *photoGRAPHic*
- En diccionarios se marca con ' antes de la sílaba tónica: /ˈtelɪfəʊn/

2.5 Transcripciones comunes en la PAU

Palabra	Transcripción
though	/ðəʊ/
thought	/θɔːt/
through	/θruː/
tough	/tʌf/
weather	/ˈweðə/
whether	/ˈweðə/
hour	/aʊə/
honest	/ˈɒnɪst/

3. WRITING (Expresión escrita para la PAU)

3.1 Estructura de un ensayo de opinión (opinion essay)

- Introducción: presenta el tema y tu opinión clara (I strongly believe that... / In my opinion...).
- Párrafo 2: Primer argumento + ejemplo (Firstly, ... For example,...)
- Párrafo 3: Segundo argumento (Moreover, ... Furthermore,...)
- Párrafo opcional de contraste (However, some people argue that... Nevertheless,...)
- Conclusión: resume tu opinión sin añadir ideas nuevas (In conclusion, ... To sum up,...)

3.2 Estructura de un ensayo de discusión (discussion essay)

- Introducción: presenta el tema y dice que hay dos posiciones (There are both advantages and disadvantages / Some people think... while others...).

- Párrafo 2: Una postura (On the one hand, ... For instance,...)
- Párrafo 3: La postura contraria (On the other hand, ... Moreover,...)
- Conclusión: tu opinión personal o un balance (In my view, the benefits outweigh the drawbacks / It depends on the situation).

3.3 Frases útiles por sección

Sección	Frases
Introducción	Nowadays, many people debate whether... / This essay will discuss... / It is often said that...
Dar opinión	I firmly believe that... / From my perspective... / As far as I am concerned... / It seems to me that...
Añadir argumentos	Firstly, ... Secondly, ... Finally, ... / What is more, ... / In addition, ... / Not only... but also...
Contraste	However, ... / On the contrary, ... / Although it is true that... / Despite this, ...
Ejemplos	For example, ... / For instance, ... / such as ... / A clear example is ...
Conclusión	In conclusion, ... / To sum up, ... / All things considered, ... / Taking everything into account, ...

3.4 Errores comunes que debes evitar

Falsos amigos y calcos

- actually ≠ actualmente (actualmente = currently / nowadays)
- assist ≠ asistir (asistir = attend)
- sensible ≠ sensible (sensible = sensitive; sensible = reasonable)
- library ≠ librería (librería = bookshop)
- exit ≠ éxito (éxito = success)
- constipated ≠ constipado (constipado = to have a cold)

Errores gramaticales frecuentes

- Olvidar la -s de la 3ª persona singular: *She work → She works
- Uso incorrecto de preposiciones: *depends of → depends on; *interested for → interested in
- Mal orden de los adjetivos: *a car red → a red car
- Falta de sujeto: *Is very important → It is very important
- Uso de 'very' con adjetivos comparativos: *very better → much better / far better
- Confundir 'for' y 'since' en presente perfecto: *I have lived here since 2 years → for 2 years / since 2020

Errores de puntuación y mayúsculas

- Los días de la semana, meses e idiomas van con mayúscula (Monday, January, English)
- No se pone coma antes de 'that' en oraciones de relativo especificativas
- La coma entre dos oraciones independientes sin conjunción es incorrecta (comma splice): *It was late, we went home → It was late, so we went home.

Errores de spelling comunes

- accommodation (una 'c', dos 'm'), beginning (dos 'n'), necessary (una 'c', dos 's'), separate (no 'e' en medio), government (la 'n'), environment (la 'n'), which (no 'w' después de 'h'), etc.
 ◆ Incorrecto: *wich, *enviroment, *acomodation → Correcto: which, environment, accommodation

4. Estrategias para el rephrasing

- Lee la oración original y entiende su significado exacto.
- Identifica la estructura gramatical que quieren que uses (condicional, pasiva, reported speech, modal, causative, etc.).
- No cambies el tiempo verbal principal a menos que la transformación lo requiera.
- Mantén el mismo sujeto cuando sea posible, o ajusta con pasiva impersonal.
- Escribe la nueva oración sin omitir información ni añadir ideas nuevas.

- Revisa la concordancia, puntuación y uso de conectores.
 - ◆ *Original: 'I regret not studying harder for the exam.'* → *Rephrase with 'wish': I wish I had studied harder for the exam.*
 - ◆ *Original: 'People believe that the company is losing money.'* → *Passive impersonal: It is believed that the company is losing money. / The company is believed to be losing money.*
 - ◆ *Original: 'Although he was ill, he went to work.'* → *Despite: Despite being ill, he went to work.*